NR2DT-05: Step 5 — Migrate Dashboards & Alerts

> **Series:** NR2DT — New Relic to Dynatrace Migration Steps | **Notebook:** 5 of 10 | **Created:** April 2026 | **Last Updated:** 10/05/2026

Overview

Goal of this step: import dashboards (Wave 1, low risk) and alerts (Wave 3, HIGH risk). Dashboards land first as read-only signal; alerts go through a 1–2 week dual-alert window before NR alerts are silenced.

Procedural — see **NRLC-03** (Dashboard Migration) and **NRLC-04** (Alert & Workflow Migration) for component depth.

Table of Contents

1. Wave 0 — Apply Foundations
2. Wave 1 — Dashboards
3. Wave 3 — Alerts (Dual-Alert)
4. Step Exit Criteria

Prerequisites

Requirement	Details
Audience	Migration lead + assigned engineer for this step

Requirement	Details
Completed	NR2DT-04 — Translate
Format	Procedural step — use as a runbook; defer to NRLC for depth
NRLC deep dives	NRLC-03, NRLC-04

1. Wave 0 — Apply Foundations

Phase-1 Terraform from Step 3 lands first.

```
cd terraform
terraform apply -target=module.buckets -target=module.host_groups \
    -target=module.iam_groups -target=module.openpipeline_enrichments
```

Wait ~45 minutes for OpenPipeline enrichment propagation on EKS clusters before Wave 2 Terraform applies any routing rules.

Validate W0:

```
fetch logs, from:-15m
| summarize records = count(), by:{dt.system.bucket}
```

Every active bucket should show ingest. If anything lands in `default_logs` for a routed source, Wave 0 isn't done.

2. Wave 1 — Dashboards

Dashboards are low-risk because they're read-only — users can compare visualizations side-by-side during the parallel run.

```
# Preview: export + transform + diff against the live tenant — imports NOTHING
python3 migrate.py migrate --dry-run --diff --components dashboards --output
./run-dashboards

# Import: the same command without --dry-run (and without --diff)
python3 migrate.py migrate --components dashboards --output ./run-dashboards
```

> **Never run `migrate` without `--dry-run`, `--export-only` or `--import-only` unless you intend to import.** `--diff` and `--report` do not make a run read-only: both run *after* the import phase, so `migrate --diff` without `--dry-run` imports first and then diffs the objects it has just created.

Review the preview's diff table (`CREATE` / `UPDATE` / `CONFLICT` / `ORPHAN`) before importing. The import run writes `./run-dashboards/rollback-manifest.json` — keep it; NR2DT-09 rolls back from it. Use a separate `--output` directory per run, because each full run overwrites the manifest in its directory. (`--import-only --input ./run-dashboards --components dashboards` imports exactly the previewed `transformed/dynatrace_config.json` instead, but writes **no** rollback manifest. `--import-only` without `--input` stops with an error.)

> **Sources:** migrate.py @ 78cbfce (tool repo, GitHub), read 10/05/2026.

W1 — Dashboard parity:

Sample 10–20% of dashboards. Open each NR dashboard and the corresponding DT document side-by-side. Acceptable diff:

- Visual layout: minor variations OK
- Data values: ±5% on count widgets
- Time-series shape: matches

Document any dashboard with > 5% delta in `wave1-issues.md` for follow-up.

3. Wave 3 — Alerts (Dual-Alert)

HIGH RISK. Follow this exactly.

Step 1: Import to silent test channels

Set `DYNATRACE_DETECTOR_ACTOR` first (NR2DT-00 §2.3) — without it the anomaly detectors fail to import.

Preview, then import (see Wave 1 for why `--dry-run` comes first):

```
python3 migrate.py migrate --dry-run --diff --components
alerts,notification_channels --output ./run-alerts
python3 migrate.py migrate --components alerts,notification_channels --output
./run-alerts
```

Component names are the ones `python3 migrate.py migrate --list-components` prints. `notifications` is not one, and the tool skips an unknown name without an error. (`alerts` also pulls in `notification_channels` as a dependency.)

Routing in this step goes to a **silent test Slack channel** (or equivalent). Update Workflow tasks to point at the test channel before enabling.

Step 2: Run dual-alert for 1–2 weeks

Both NR and DT raise alerts. Compare volume daily:

```
// One record per problem: count distinct problems, not problem updates
fetch dt.davis.problems, from:-1d
| summarize problems = countDistinct(display_id), by:{event.name,
event.category}
| sort problems desc
```

Count problems from `dt.davis.problems`, not from `fetch events | filter event.kind == "DAVIS_PROBLEM"`. The `events` form returns one record per problem *update*: over the same 24 h on the validation tenant (10/05/2026) it returned 15,738 records for 465 distinct problems — about 34× the real number, which would make the ±10% comparison meaningless.

DT problem count should match NR alert count within ±10% per condition. Investigate any condition with > 25% delta.

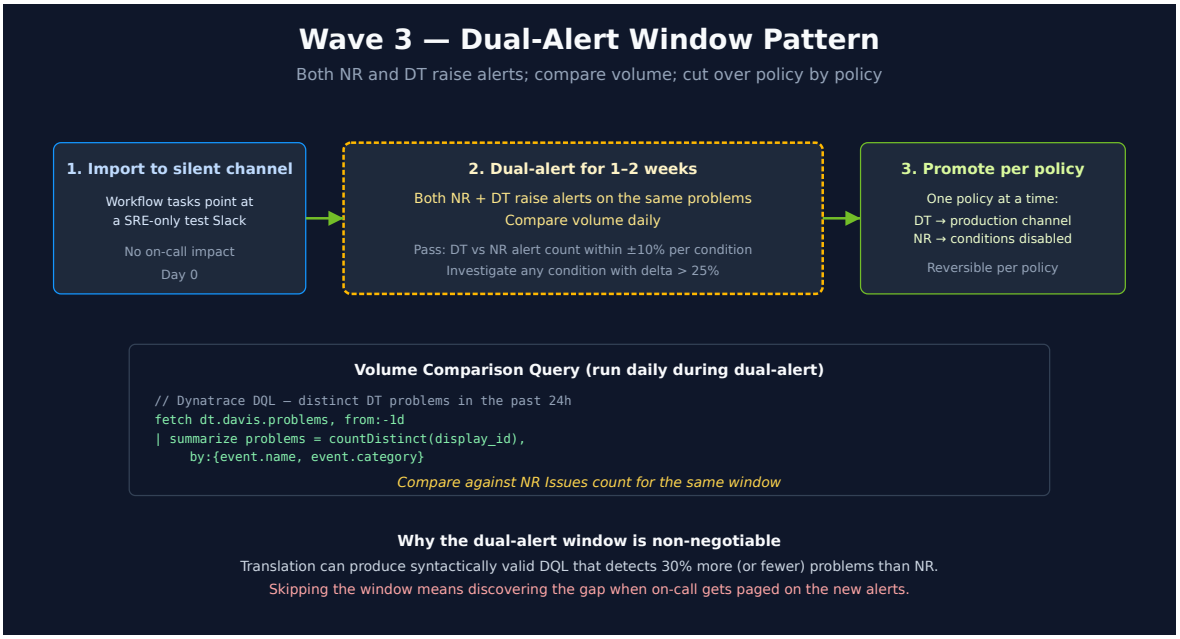
Step 3: Promote per policy

One policy at a time. When a policy's dual-alert volume aligns:

1. Update its Workflow tasks to point at the production channel (re-enter secrets in DT credentials vault)
2. Disable all of that policy's conditions in NR — a New Relic policy has no on/off state of its own: *"You can't disable a policy directly. However, you can disable all of the policy's conditions."*
3. Move to the next policy

Don't batch — sequential cutover lets you reverse one policy without affecting others.

> **Sources:** Create, edit, or find an alert policy (New Relic docs), read 10/05/2026.



4. Step Exit Criteria

S5 — Dashboards + Alerts Migrated

- [ ] All Wave 0 Foundations applied; W0 validated
- [ ] All dashboards migrated; W1 visual-diff sample passed
- [ ] All alert policies migrated; dual-alert window completed (≥ 1 week)
- [ ] W3 dual-alert volume aligned within ±10%
- [ ] All notification secrets re-entered in DT credentials vault
- [ ] NR conditions disabled for migrated policies only (NR ingest still on)

Next step: NR2DT-06 — Migrate Synthetics, SLOs, Workloads.

This notebook was AI-generated from community-submitted and publicly available sources, including the open-source NewRelic-to-Dynatrace-Migration-Utilities, nrql-engine, and nrql-translator projects. This

notebook series is not officially supported by Dynatrace or New Relic. Always verify information against the official Dynatrace documentation and New Relic documentation.